

install before wandering on the web. Sometimes software that you never suspected may be connecting to the internet without your knowledge, and without an outbound firewall, you will not know, nor be able to do anything about it. Software like Little Snitch 3 and Intego Net Barrier overcomes this limitation, allowing you to monitor and filter outgoing connections as well as incoming connections.

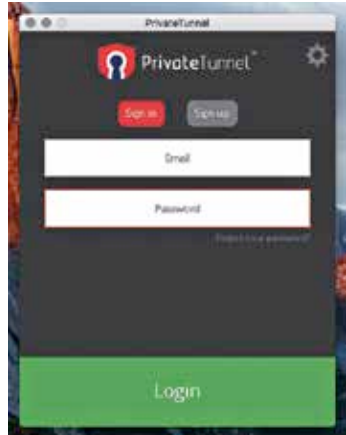
Purchasing Privately

The urge to shop is a powerful one, it can rival almost any addiction. Retail therapy is ever more accessible thanks to the modern ability to shop online and purchase with a few clicks. If ever this urge strikes you when you are using a public connection, like an airport or coffee house wifi network, your precious transaction data can be sniffed by an enterprising lurker. After all, what can be more lucrative information than credit/debit card numbers and passwords. Fortunately, most online transactions are secured

by additional protocols so it is not super risky to order your groceries online before you board your flight. Besides making sure your connection is encrypted using [https](#), you can use a virtual private network (VPN) to ensure that extra level of safety. VPNs offer an added layer of encryption and anonymity on the internet no matter when your entry node is physically located. Carrying out transactions and other sensitive communication over a VPN is sure to foil any attempts of sabotage from sniffed information.

Logging in Manually

By default, Macs are set to login automatically on boot, which makes things especially easy if you are the sole user of your system. While this is a great feature for the perpetually lazy, it is a potential security hazard for people whose system resides in a high traffic area and can be easily physically stolen. Once someone else picks up your precious Mac, all they have to do is open the screen and they are in. To disable this double-edged feature, open System Preferences, and inside Users & Groups you will find Login Options. Here



Make yourself anonymous, use a VPN